

Associates and Network General declared consolidation and Network Associates was born. This company promised antivirus solutions in addition to encryption and network administration services. This was the birth of NAI. Eventually, Dr Solomon was bought by NAI for US \$640 million. The event shocked the antivirus world as the conflict between the two antivirus giants was made a thing of the past with a simple bargain. In the process, one of the most notable and technologically strong antivirus software manufacturers lost its identity.

The year 1999 opened a chapter which even today, poses a major threat. Melissa was the first combination of a macro virus and a worm. It used Outlook and Outlook Express to send itself to others via e-mail. Antivirus software scrambled to scan your e-mails, certify virus free e-mails and clog bandwidth with unfortunate and needed overhead. Melissa, of course birthed similar threats: the e-mail worms.

Today, the virus threat has increased a level where simple antivirus packages no longer cut it. With Spyware, Worms, Trojans and other malicious software attacking from every medium, we now need more complete security solutions. Indeed, Microsoft has taken security to heart (never too late to start) and is promising to fight the threat of malicious software headlong.

3.2 The Mind Of A Virus Writer

So what makes a person create a virus? What is he trying to prove by spreading chaos and destruction that can only win him jail-time if caught? The popular perception of a virus writer is that of a dysfunctional, pimple-faced teenager; with no girlfriend and no life, who taps out malicious code to a backbeat of trance music. It is a very Hollywood profile and not exactly the most accurate profile. Recent research shows that most virus coders are well-adjusted youths who have normal relationships with their family and friends and intend no real harm with the viruses they write... which is a big problem.